displeased with Nehru's powerful clout with the British, which had forced him to permit Nehru's entry into his state. The differences between the Maharaja and Nehru were to grow wider in the years to come.

In 1944, Kak engineered Jinnah's visit to Srinagar and got him to mediate between the Muslim Conference and the National Conference in an effort to unite the two warring factions that were both working towards the same intrinsic goal. However, Jinnah was unsuccessful and ended up endorsing the Muslim Conference as the only sincere representative of the suffering Muslim masses of the state. This helped Kak introduce the nascent idea of Pakistan to the Maharaja.

Looming Threats

But in 1946, the state's security faced newer threats. Tibet had *de facto* independence and was one of the countries that shared a border with Jammu and Kashmir. In order to secure India's borders, the British Government was willing to provide military support to Tibet. In the same year, the British Government officials prepared a confidential memo entitled, 'Appreciation of the scale of direct military assistance which could be provided in support of Tibet'.[3] According to this memo, Russia and China were potential threats to India's security. The memo proposed a line passing through Chamdo, Nagchuka, Garyarsa and Leh, and opined that any invasion by Russians or Chinese from south of this line would prove to be highly dangerous for India's security. The area south of this proposed line was to be the buffer zone between India and the two expansionist powers of Russia and China. This memo emphasised on the crucial role the state of Jammu and Kashmir played in maintaining India's military defence. Before this memo was written, India's Secretary of External Affairs, Sir Olaf Caroe, had stated that the Gilgit-Kashgar boundary was the only direct contact point between India and China, and that no other contact points should be added. Caroe was made the Governor of the NWFP, succeeding Sir George Cunningham in late 1946. Thereafter, he was succeeded by